



KHANATURAL

DECEMBER 2024

THABO AFITLHILE
IS ONE TO WATCH

WHAT IS AN AFRICAN
CHRISTMAS MEAL?

Joy
Magagula



Khabonina
Q

Editor-in-Chief



DEC 2024

Editor's Note

We will never stop providing the best content related to health & wellness in a magazine. It is my commitment and the entire KhanaturalMag team to always provide the latest and most substantive content on the local and international wellness scene because we believe our readers deserve the best.

In this issue

We walk the streets of Soweto with Filmmaker Thabo Afitlhile. Let's be frank and discuss your Christmas menu as an African and Miss Earth certainly brings Joy to KhanaturalMag this season!

Image by : PhotoFit photographers



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YOUR AFRICAN FESTIVE RECIPE

Isaac Diloru, a producer, director & good friend of Khanatural says: "Christmas was never an African holiday."



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JOY TO THE WORLD



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JOY OF NATURE



*I consistently find ways to fuse together
my passions in order to have a positive
impact on the world!*

My Team never ceases to amaze me !!!

I worked with the wonderful Team of Miss Earth SA over 6 years ago. What an incredible journey it was. I enjoyed meeting the hopeful passionate contestants , plus the entire Miss Earth production team is heartwarming.

Fast forward to 2024 , I'm introduced to the reigning AIR queen, Joy Magagula ! Wow . She's a vibrant and multifaceted individual with brains to match . This UCT Law Graduate & entrepreneur knows the kind of future shes carving for herself ! What blew us away is her MC skills , I call her the people whisperer, but wait , she applies the same skill when communicating with animals , so an animal whisperer too!

Our meeting was "Safari" themed and this Environmentalist, and a fibre artist and designer pulled out all the stops by introducing us to her pets . Ps. we at Khanatural love pets too, so this was a definite WIN !

Speaking to us , while gently patting her cat Akani aka Kiki , Joy shares more : "As a creative at heart, I consistently find ways to fuse together my passions in order to have a positive impact on the world!"

Joy is known for her proactive and love-filled approach to empowering people whether it's through her tree plantings, school garden projects, and teaching individuals from around the world how to get creative through crochet while teaching them about sustainable fashion and how to advocate for environmental issues through law. - thats not just a mouth full but a brain full too !!! Wow!

Q & A



Kha: "Where do you spend most of your time?"

Joy : "well , As an active person , I spend most of my time in nature. My love for nature inspires most of my work" !

Kha: "Please tell our readers about your OTHER business !"

Joy : "I have a handmade jewellery business 'KAI' which holds collections that embody mother earth herself."

Kha: "We know you're a sea fairy , you must know about seamoss , your thoughts?"

Joy : " So as my nickname goes in Cape Town, I am a seafairy. I love the ocean and spend a lot of time there and trying to learn about different elements there,so yes! I know seamoss and its extensive benefits!"

Joy is passionate about breaking down the walls that limit people from access to environmental education. She strives to empower people to understand the individual and collective power and skills that they possess that can help us build a better and sustainable planet.

She's definitely our Superhero !!!

"what I like the most about seamoss is its versatility in how you can consume and use it. I personally like it in a smoothie." - Joy Magagula



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WITH JOY

A FESTIVE RECIPE FOR BALANCE AND JOY

It's that time of year when we pause to reflect on our lives. We think about our accomplishments, the challenges we've faced, and the things we've lost. - BY DAMBISA MAQOGA

As the festive season approaches, it's not just a time for celebration but also an opportunity to prioritise what truly matters, our well-being.

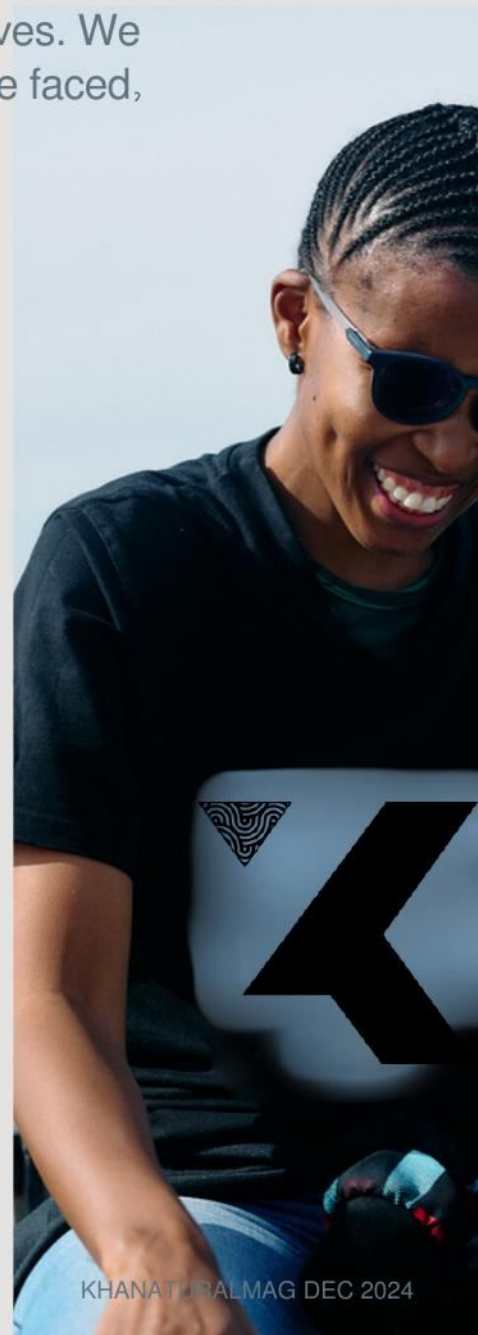
For many of us, this year has been hectic, emotionally, financially, and physically. Amid the chaos, have we made time to care for ourselves? For most, the answer is probably no. As we think about the joy and togetherness the festive period brings, it's worth considering how we've prioritized our well-being through the obstacles, grief, and tough moments this year.

Often, our well-being takes a backseat as we chase deadlines and strive to restore balance in our lives. But I want to remind you: your well-being matters. Health isn't just about eating right or hitting the gym four times a week. It's about cultivating a space free of negative or destructive energy and intentionally caring for your mental, emotional, and physical health. Why? Because a solid foundation of well-being helps us navigate life's challenges and bounce back when things don't go our way.

Think of life as a bowl of Korean noodle soup - rich, complex, and occasionally overwhelming. Sometimes it's delicious, and other times, not so much. Maintaining good well-being is like mastering the recipe, it ensures we can savour the good moments and endure the bad.

As we enter the festive season, let's do so with ease and confidence, knowing we've prioritised ourselves. And if we haven't, let's commit to starting now. Remember, your well-being is your responsibility. It's not something you can delegate to your loved ones, as they have their own well-being to nurture. When you put yourself first, everything else tends to fall into place.

For me, while I admit to being lazy with health routines like exercising and eating clean, I make a conscious effort to invest in my mental and emotional well-being. Even when the budget is tight, I prioritise being mentally free, and that's how I've navigated this "noodle soup-ish" life. When storms come, it's my daily practices of nurturing my well-being that keep me afloat.



THABO IS HERE!



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THE ONE TO WATCH NOW

THABO AFITLHILE

"As a storyteller, my well-being directly impacts the quality of my work. I am a vessel, and when I'm healthy, I can create from a place of authenticity and passion." - Thabo Afi !



We love catching up with our faves while they're knee deep in their passion ! We arrived on set in Meadowlands where Thabo is shooting a short film ala music video ! They allowed us to occupy their greenroom! However, We also couldn't sit still , for Khanatural is a movement, we couldn't resist a walk down the streets of our fave township , Soweto!

In pursuit of depth and artistry, Thabo immersed himself in studies at The Market Theatre Laboratory, where he refined his acting and writing skills, surrounded by a vibrant community of local and international creatives.

Thabo, a writer and director whose creativity and potential know no bounds. His journey began in high school drama competitions, where his passion for the craft ignited and ultimately led him to formal training with Youth In Trust (YIT) Academy, under mentors Ayanda Sithebe and Nelson Mokoena. These formative years became the launching pad for a lifelong devotion to storytelling, with his first TV role on SABC 2's acclaimed 90 Plein Street in 2009, followed by captivating roles in Tv films. Each role cemented his love for the arts and his commitment to South African narratives.

We asked him about the importance of wellness in this industry, he says "Wellness in the film industry is vital, especially for someone like me, drawn to action-oriented stories that demand intense physical preparation and execution during pre-production and shooting. Between imagination and reality, the mental and physical toll of a production can be significant."

Thabo's training enriched his unique approach to storytelling, infusing his work with the authenticity and passion that have come to define his voice.



THABO



THABO ON SEAMOSS :

Yes!!! I'm a lover of oceans and rivers. Seamoss has a unique oceanic flavor with earthy and slightly salty notes. Being from Joburg, its taste reminds me of the fresh, invigorating air by the ocean. I need more of it!

As a director, Thabo's journey was championed by the late Asivhanzhi Matabe, who saw his potential and provided invaluable support through the NFVF Youth Filmmakers Program. Under the mentorship of Thuso Sibisi and Adze Ugah, Thabo's talents flourished, earning him two international awards in 2021.

Drawing further inspiration from revered directors like Eric Mogale and Neo Matsunyana, Thabo's dedication shines through each project, as he weaves compelling stories that resonate deeply with audiences.

Thabo Afithile is a beacon of inspiration, his life, a testament to the power of passion, purpose, and relentless dedication. With an extraordinary journey rooted in creativity and social impact, Thabo's story is one of greatness in the making, a narrative that promises to inspire for years to come.

"BECOMING THABO" - The Movie

We asked him if a movie or docu-series was made about him, who'd best do it justice : "It would be Thabang Matona, originally from Soweto and now based in the USA. I first met him a few years ago during a motivational session I hosted at his high school in Meadowlands. From there his passion, personal growth, and the values he embodies deeply resonated with me, aligning with many I hold dear. I believe Thabang would intuitively connect with my story—the environment, the themes, and the message the docu-film seeks to convey, all rooted in realness."

We see what he did there "Rooted in Realness" - our #Khanatural Tagline

CONTINUA

South Africa, what's your Christmas dish recipe?

Let's Eat!

Many South Africans still follow the old Christmas traditions of their British ancestors. The Christmas meal may consist of roasted meats and vegetables, followed by a rich fruit pudding and custard. Crackers are pulled before the meal. These pop when pulled apart and contain small gifts, jokes and paper crowns which everyone at the table wears. Other Christmas foods include fruit mincemeat pies and fruitcake. Descendants of other European nations often continue the traditions of their ancestors.

Isaak Diloró , a producer, director & good friend of Khanatural says : “Christmas was never an African holiday.”

We love this point of view as it's been discussed in a couple of African boardrooms. Why is our “December person covered in snow & draped in winter gear ... and the North Pole involvement in Africa & so much more not in sync with our continent ?!”

Isaac continues, “We as Africans did not come up with the concept of Christmas and it was never ours to begin with, the people who brought it to us introduced it with its traditions and just like everything else that is commemorated, its original traditions have to be upheld so it's not surprising to see us celebrate it in this way. Any modifications done have to be justified by practicality (or impracticality), which there aren't any so far.

Ps. Please note , This article doesn't discuss whether it is right or wrong to celebrate it.

What we are saying , In conclusion, If you're going to celebrate Christmas then remember, ‘when you're in Rome, you must do what the Romans do’ (the way they do it).

Have a blessed festive dear friends.



*Tsaki
Khoza*



trend

YOUNG TALENTED WITH VALUES

ONE TO WATCH

NEXT ...

 KHANATURAL

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